

BIDSCOPE ONE

The Complete Government Tender Intelligence & Bid-Readiness Platform

One platform combining opportunity matching, compliance checking, market intelligence, partner matching and deadline management.

Ontario / Ottawa launch plan | Extremely detailed founder + technical build manual

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What this document is

A practical build manual. It explains exactly what to create, what accounts to open, the order to build features, the data model, the software stack, legal/compliance checkpoints, testing, pricing and launch. It is not legal, accounting or tax advice; regulated questions should be confirmed with the relevant authority or qualified professional before launch.

How to use this guide

- Part I - The single business idea and how the five modules work together
- Part II - Legal/company setup in Ontario and Ottawa
- Part III - Every tool/account to install or create
- Part IV - Technical architecture and database
- Part V - Build the product step by step
- Part VI - Data ingestion and government-data attribution
- Part VII - Security, privacy, email and payments
- Part VIII - Pricing, sales, launch and operations
- Part IX - 90-day execution plan and launch checklists
- Appendices - folder structure, SQL starter schema, environment variables, QA tests and source links

Recommended founder strategy

Do not build all five modules at full depth before talking to customers. Build one integrated product, but release it in layers: (1) Opportunity Radar + Bid Calendar, (2) Eligibility Checker, (3) Market Intelligence, (4) Partner Network. The later modules reuse the same tender database, company profiles and authentication system, so you are building one product rather than starting over four times.

PART I - THE SINGLE BIG IDEA

1. What you are building

BidScope One is a business-to-business software platform for Canadian companies that want to sell to government. A supplier creates a company profile once. The platform continuously turns public procurement data and the supplier's own documents into five connected workflows: find the right opportunities, understand mandatory requirements, research buyers and past awards, find missing partners, and manage every deadline.

Module	What the customer gets	Why it belongs in the same product
1. Opportunity Radar	Matched federal/public-sector tenders ranked by fit, with plain-language reasons.	Uses the company profile + normalized tender database.
2. Eligibility Checker	Upload a bid package; extract mandatory conditions, forms, dates, clearances, insurance, experience and submission rules.	Uses the same opportunity record and company profile.
3. Market Intelligence	Buyer history, previous awards, supplier activity, contract values, categories and contract-history views.	Uses award, contract-history and standing-offer datasets linked to opportunities.
4. Partner Network	Find primes/subcontractors/capability partners when a company lacks a requirement.	Uses capability gaps detected by matching/eligibility.
5. Bid Calendar	Closing dates, amendment alerts, internal tasks, document due dates and team reminders.	Uses every other module's deadlines and workflow state.

2. Core user journey

1. A business signs up and creates a company profile: services, regions, capabilities, typical contract size, certifications, insurance, security-clearance capability, languages and past work categories.
2. The Opportunity Radar imports current tender data and scores every suitable tender against that profile.
3. The user opens a tender and sees match reasons, risk flags and the official source link. The platform never replaces the official solicitation documents.
4. If the user uploads the solicitation package, the Eligibility Checker creates a checklist where every extracted requirement points back to the source page/section.
5. Market Intelligence shows relevant historical buyers, awards and suppliers from official public procurement datasets.
6. If the user lacks a capability, the Partner Network can surface verified businesses with that capability. Users control outreach.
7. The Bid Calendar turns the opportunity into a working bid: closing date, question deadline, mandatory forms, internal owner, reminders and status.
8. After award/cancel/close, the record remains in the customer workspace for learning and pipeline reporting.

3. What NOT to build at the beginning

- Do not build your own escrow/wallet.

- Do not promise that a company is “eligible” or will win; show extracted requirements and evidence.
- Do not auto-submit bids to procurement portals in the MVP.
- Do not scrape sites when an official downloadable dataset is available.
- Do not create a giant nationwide partner marketplace before one vertical has liquidity.
- Do not store raw payment-card data; use hosted payment pages.
- Do not use hidden black-box match scores without showing the factors behind them.

PART II - COMPANY, LICENCES, TAX AND LEGAL SETUP

4. Recommended structure

For a paid SaaS platform holding business profile data and customer-uploaded procurement documents, an Ontario business corporation is the cleanest default starting structure for this plan. Ontario currently lists the online government filing fee for a Business Corporation at \$300. A sole proprietorship is cheaper (\$60) but is not a separate legal entity. [S1]

Important

Incorporation is a business/risk choice, not a special “government tender software licence.” The exact tax/legal structure should be confirmed with an accountant or lawyer if ownership, investors, non-resident founders, share classes or intellectual property ownership are complex.

5. Click-by-click Ontario setup

9. **Choose 3 names** - Keep a first choice and two backups. Search the Ontario Business Registry. If incorporating under a name rather than a numbered company, Ontario says a qualifying Ontario-biased/weighted NUANS report is required. [S1]
10. **Create Ontario access** - Create/sign in with Ontario.ca Login and create an Ontario Business Account. [S2]
11. **File incorporation** - Open the Ontario “Register your business online” page, choose Business Corporation, enter registered office, incorporator/director information and share details, and pay the current \$300 government filing fee. Save the certificate/articles immediately. [S1]
12. **Build a corporate records folder** - Create: 01 Incorporation; 02 Tax; 03 Banking; 04 Contracts; 05 Privacy-Security; 06 Insurance; 07 IP-Trademark; 08 Vendor Accounts.
13. **Open business banking** - Use the exact legal name and corporation documents. Keep customer revenue and company expenses out of personal accounts.
14. **Register with CRA** - Use CRA Business Registration Online through your CRA account to obtain/manage the Business Number and add program accounts when needed. CRA states that, since July 14, 2026, BRO access requires sign-in through a CRA account. [S3]
15. **GST/HST decision** - Track taxable revenues from day one. The normal small-supplier threshold is \$30,000; registration timing depends on how the threshold is crossed. You can also register voluntarily. [S4]
16. **Run BizPaL** - Enter the actual location and actual software/information-service activity in BizPaL to identify permits/licences that could apply. Save the result as a PDF. [S5]
17. **Home-office check** - If operating from home in Ottawa, review Zoning By-law 2026-50 s.301. It permits home-based businesses where residential use is permitted, subject to nuisance, hazard and other conditions. [S6]
18. **Insurance quotes** - Before larger customers, obtain quotes for commercial general liability plus technology E&O/cyber coverage. The amount is commercial/risk dependent, not a universal software licence requirement.

6. Privacy and marketing rules to design for

Area	Build requirement	Source
PIPEDA/privacy	Appoint a privacy owner; publish understandable privacy practices; collect only needed personal information; use meaningful consent; maintain breach handling and access/correction processes.	Office of the Privacy Commissioner business guide [S7]
CASL	For commercial emails/texts, build consent records, sender identification/contact information and a working unsubscribe process. ISED explains express/implied consent and says unsubscribe requests must be actioned within 10 business days.	ISED CASL guidance [S8]
Open-data licence	Attribute source information and do not imply government endorsement. The Open Government Licence - Canada permits commercial reuse subject to its conditions.	Open Government Licence [S9]
Marketplace payments	Avoid holding partner funds in the MVP. Bank of Canada policy explains that some marketplaces involved in payment functions can fall under the RPAA; using third-party PSPs end-to-end can change the analysis.	Bank of Canada [S10]
Money-service risk	If you later operate activities that make you an MSB, FINTRAC registration obligations can apply. Do not build your own remittance/escrow/wallet without Canadian legal review.	FINTRAC [S11]

PART III - EVERY TOOL / ACCOUNT YOU WILL USE

7. The recommended stack

Purpose	Tool	Why this choice	Install / sign-up
Wireframes/UI	Figma	Design dashboard screens before coding.	figma.com/downloads
Code editor	Visual Studio Code	Free, strong TypeScript/Next.js tooling.	code.visualstudio.com/Download
JavaScript runtime	Node.js LTS	Runs Next.js tooling and package manager.	nodejs.org/en/download
Git client	GitHub Desktop + GitHub	Easy version control/backup for a first-time founder.	desktop.github.com/download
Frontend/backend web app	Next.js + TypeScript	One codebase for pages, server routes and APIs.	nextjs.org/docs
Database + auth	Supabase/PostgreSQL	Managed Postgres, authentication, storage and row-level security.	supabase.com/dashboard
Hosting	Vercel	Fast Next.js deployments and preview environments.	vercel.com/signup
Document storage	Cloudflare R2	S3-compatible object storage for tender/customer files.	dash.cloudflare.com + developers.cloudflare.com/r2
Payments	Stripe Checkout + Billing	Hosted payment collection and subscriptions.	dashboard.stripe.com/register
Partner payouts - later	Stripe Connect	Use a PSP rather than creating your own wallet/escrow.	stripe.com/connect
Transactional email	Postmark	Password/alert/account emails with domain authentication.	postmarkapp.com
Error monitoring	Sentry	Application exceptions and release monitoring.	sentry.io
Product analytics	PostHog	Funnels, feature usage; configure to avoid sensitive content.	posthog.com
Password manager	Bitwarden or 1Password	Store service credentials, recovery codes and secrets.	bitwarden.com/download or 1password.com/downloads
Accounting	QuickBooks Online or Xero	Invoices, expense categorization, tax/accounting workflow.	quickbooks.intuit.com/ca or xero.com/ca

8. Install local developer tools - exact order

19. Install Visual Studio Code from the official download page. Accept the Windows installer defaults and enable “Add to PATH” if offered.
20. Install the current Node.js LTS release from nodejs.org. After installation, open PowerShell and run: `node -v` and `npm -v`. Both should print versions.
21. Install GitHub Desktop. Sign into a GitHub account protected by MFA. Create a private repository called `bidscope-one`.
22. Install Figma desktop if you prefer a desktop app; otherwise use the browser version.

23. Create a password-manager vault named BidScope One. Store registrar, email, GitHub, Supabase, Vercel, Stripe and recovery codes there.
24. Create a local folder such as C:\Projects\bidscope-one. Clone the private repository into it with GitHub Desktop.

9. Create the web project

```
npx create-next-app@latest bidscope-one --typescript --eslint --tailwind --app  
cd bidscope-one  
npm run dev
```

Open <http://localhost:3000>. If the starter page loads, stop the dev server with Ctrl+C, commit the starter project in GitHub Desktop, and push it.

10. Create cloud accounts in this order

25. Supabase: create two projects, bidscope-staging and bidscope-production. Use different database passwords. Do not paste production service-role keys into chat, email or source control.
26. Vercel: import the GitHub repository. The default production branch should be main. Use Preview deployments for non-main branches.
27. Cloudflare: add/transfer the product domain if desired, then create an R2 bucket such as bidscope-documents-prod. Keep customer tender documents private.
28. Postmark: add the sending domain/subdomain, then configure the DNS records Postmark gives you. Use a transactional stream for product notifications and a separate broadcast stream if you later send marketing.
29. Stripe: create the Canadian business account using the legal company details. Stay in Test Mode until all checkout/webhook tests pass.
30. Sentry: create a Next.js project and keep request bodies/document content out of error logs.
31. PostHog: create a project. Disable/avoid capture of document contents, tender attachments and sensitive profile fields.

PART IV - TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE

11. High-level architecture

Browser

- > Next.js application on Vercel
- > Supabase Auth (users / organizations)
- > Supabase Postgres (tenders, profiles, matches, awards, tasks)
- > Cloudflare R2 (private uploaded PDFs / attachments)
- > Scheduled import worker / GitHub Actions
 - > CanadaBuys official downloadable datasets
- > Postmark (alerts / account email)
- > Stripe (subscriptions)
- > Sentry / PostHog (operational telemetry with sensitive-data filtering)

12. Core database model

Table	Purpose	Critical fields
organizations	Customer company/tenant.	id, legal_name, trade_name, domain, regions, subscription_status
users	Account users.	id, organization_id, email, role, last_login_at
company_profiles	Matching profile.	capabilities, categories, regions, min/max_value, languages, clearance_notes, insurance, certifications
tenders	Normalized procurement opportunity.	source_id, title, buyer, category, dates, status, source_url, source_updated_at, raw_hash
tender_documents	Official/customer docs.	tender_id, object_key, document_type, source, checksum, page_count
matches	Opportunity-company score.	organization_id, tender_id, score, factor_json, created_at
requirements	Eligibility checklist items.	tender_id, text, requirement_type, mandatory, source_page, source_quote_ref, due_date
organization_evidence	Company evidence for requirements.	type, issuer, valid_from, expiry_date, object_key, verification_state
awards	Published award notices.	source_id, buyer, supplier_name, value, award_date, category
contract_history	PSPC contract-history records.	source_id, supplier, department, value, dates, description
standing_offers	Standing offers/supply arrangements.	supplier, instrument, category, dates, source_id
partner_posts	Partner/capability requests.	organization_id, tender_id, role_needed, tags, deadline, visibility
partner_matches	Potential company-to-post match.	partner_post_id, target_org_id, score, reasons
watchlists	Saved search rules.	organization_id, query_json, active
bid_projects	Customer pursuit/workspace.	organization_id, tender_id, owner_id, stage, go_no_go, notes
tasks	Deadlines/actions.	bid_project_id, owner_id, title, due_at, status, source_requirement_id
notifications	Email/in-app delivery record.	user_id, type, payload, sent_at, delivery_status
audit_events	Sensitive actions.	organization_id, user_id, action,

		object_type, object_id, created_at
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13. Multi-tenant security model

- Every customer-owned row has organization_id.
- Supabase Row Level Security (RLS) is enabled before real customer data is loaded.
- Normal browser users never receive the Supabase service-role key.
- Private R2 files are accessed with short-lived signed URLs generated by server-side code.
- Admin/support impersonation is avoided in MVP; if later added, every action is audited.
- Company-to-company marketplace data is public/private according to explicit visibility fields, never because RLS is missing.

14. Match scoring - transparent, not magical

Start with deterministic weighted matching. Store each factor and show it to the customer. A first version can use a 100-point score:

Factor	Example weight	How to score
Capability/category match	30	Exact/strong taxonomy matches + keyword overlap.
Geography / delivery region	15	Full points if allowed/served; zero or warning if outside region.
Contract-size fit	10	Compare tender value/range when present to supplier target size.
Security/clearance fit	15	Confirmed capability or explicit missing/unknown flag.
Certification/insurance	10	Match documented requirements against profile evidence.
Language / onsite constraints	10	Compare French/bilingual/onsite/location requirements.
Past-work relevance	10	Related categories/buyers/keywords from user-entered past projects.

Score rule

Never hide a mandatory mismatch behind a high numeric score. If a tender explicitly requires something the profile lacks, show a red “mandatory risk” flag even if the overall relevance is high.

PART V - BUILD THE PRODUCT STEP BY STEP

15. Phase 0 - Design the screens before coding

32. In Figma create a project named BidScope One.
33. Design desktop-first screens: Sign in; Onboarding; Dashboard; Opportunities; Opportunity Detail; Eligibility; Intelligence; Partners; Bid Calendar; Company Profile; Billing; Settings.
34. On the Dashboard place only four primary widgets initially: New Matches, Closing Soon, Active Bids and Alerts.
35. For each Opportunity Detail screen include: title, buyer, status, dates, official source link, match score, match reasons, mandatory-risk flags, Save/Start Bid button.
36. Prototype the flow from login -> profile -> first match -> start bid -> task calendar before writing the feature code.

16. Phase 1 - Authentication and onboarding

37. Configure Supabase Auth for email/password or magic-link login.
38. Create organization automatically when the first owner signs up.
39. Create onboarding form sections: company basics; capabilities; locations; target contract size; categories; language; security-clearance capability; certifications/insurance; notification preferences.
40. Save incomplete onboarding as draft. Do not force users to upload sensitive documents just to browse opportunities.
41. Create role values owner, admin, member. Only owner/admin can edit billing and organization settings.
42. Add a “delete account / request deletion” workflow and an export request route before launch.

17. Phase 2 - Government data import

CanadaBuys publishes downloadable procurement datasets for tender notices, award notices, contract history and standing offers/supply arrangements. Its data page explicitly says the data can be used for market research, finding potential business partners, analyzing markets, and more. [S12]

43. Create a server-side import job; never run bulk imports from the browser.
44. Download the official current/open tender dataset into a temporary file.
45. Validate required columns and date formats before touching production tables.
46. Normalize buyer names, province/territory values, category strings, dates and source URLs.
47. Use source identifiers plus a content hash to UPSERT instead of creating duplicates.
48. Mark records changed since the prior import. Those changes drive amendment/deadline alerts.
49. Keep raw-source snapshots or raw-json metadata long enough to debug parsing, but do not present your cache as the authoritative solicitation.
50. Repeat for awards, contract history and standing offers. Link records using available identifiers and normalized supplier/buyer fields; keep a confidence field when links are heuristic.

18. Phase 3 - Opportunity Radar

51. Create /opportunities page with filters: keyword, buyer, category, region, closing window, status, and minimum match score.
52. Run matching after each import for active customer organizations. For MVP, you can compute on demand for each logged-in customer rather than precomputing the entire cross-product.
53. Show “Why this matches”: capability terms, geographic fit, buyer/category relevance, size fit and known requirements.
54. Show “Potential blockers”: clearance, insurance, certifications, language, onsite restrictions, mandatory experience when known.
55. Add Save, Dismiss and Start Bid actions. Use dismissed records to improve filters but do not silently change scoring logic without showing users.
56. Every opportunity has an obvious button: “Open official notice.”

19. Phase 4 - Bid Calendar and alerts

57. When user clicks Start Bid, create a bid_project linked to the tender.
58. Copy the official closing date into a task and mark it locked-to-source; allow internal buffer dates separately.
59. Add tasks for: go/no-go decision; clarification questions; partner confirmation; draft technical; pricing; review; signatures; upload/submission; final verification.
60. Create reminder preferences: 14 days, 7 days, 72 hours, 24 hours; user can change them.
61. On every new import, compare closing date/status and relevant text hash. If changed, create an amendment event and notify affected watchlists/bid projects.
62. Never claim an emailed alert is the official deadline; include official source link and “verify before submission.”

20. Phase 5 - Eligibility / Compliance Checker

This module must be traceable. Its job is to organize evidence, not to provide a legal guarantee that a bidder qualifies.

63. Upload: user selects a tender/bid project and uploads PDF/DOCX files. Store private files in R2 and metadata/checksum in Postgres.
64. Extraction: for text PDFs, extract text with page boundaries. For scanned pages, add OCR later; in MVP you can reject scans with a clear message or queue them for manual/OCR processing.
65. Chunk by document/page/section. Never lose page references.
66. Identify candidate requirements using rules/phrases such as “must”, “mandatory”, “shall”, “required”, “minimum”, “security clearance”, “insurance”, “submission”, “closing”, “experience”, “reference”, “certification”, “form”.
67. Create structured requirement records: type, mandatory yes/no/uncertain, exact source page, short source excerpt reference, due date, evidence needed, status.
68. Compare to company evidence only where structured facts exist. Example: requirement says \$2M CGL and evidence record says \$1M -> flag mismatch. If not enough data, label Unknown, not Fail.
69. UI: left side document/page; right side checklist. Clicking a checklist item jumps to the page/source context.
70. Require user confirmation for every mandatory item before the checklist can be marked reviewed.

71. Add export-to-PDF/CSV checklist later, but keep the original official documents and official notice links visible.

21. Phase 6 - Market Intelligence

72. Create buyer page: department/organization, categories, recent tender count, published awards, known contract history, standing offers/supply arrangements, common suppliers.
73. Create supplier page using public records: normalized supplier name, published awards, categories, buyers and dates. Clearly label that same/similar company names may require disambiguation.
74. Create category page: open opportunities, historical awards, buyer activity and typical published values where data supports it.
75. Add search: “show awards by buyer X for category Y from date A to date B.”
76. Do not present causal conclusions such as “buyer prefers supplier X” solely from award counts. Show records and descriptive statistics.
77. Cache aggregate tables nightly so dashboards remain fast.

22. Phase 7 - Partner Network

78. Start in one vertical where teaming is common, such as IT professional services or construction subcontracting.
79. Allow companies to opt into a discoverable profile. Default private for information not explicitly published.
80. Profile fields: capabilities, regions, languages, company size band, security-clearance capability, certifications with expiry, past-project categories and contact permissions.
81. Create “Need a partner” from a bid project. Pre-fill capability gaps detected by the Eligibility Checker, but user edits before publishing.
82. Match candidate partners by capabilities, region, deadlines and required credentials.
83. First 20-50 matches should be concierge/manual: you personally validate whether the algorithm is useful.
84. Monetize with subscriptions or paid partner posts at first. Do not hold subcontract payments.
85. If later facilitating payouts, use a third-party PSP such as Stripe Connect end-to-end and obtain Canadian legal advice on RPAA/FINTRAC implications before changing the flow of funds.

PART VI - DATA PIPELINE, ATTRIBUTION AND DOCUMENT HANDLING

23. Official datasets to use

Dataset	Use in BidScope One	Official source
Tender notices	Opportunity Radar, deadline/change monitoring.	CanadaBuys procurement data page -> Tender notices [S12]
Award notices	Market Intelligence; historical supplier/buyer activity.	CanadaBuys -> Award notices [S12]
Contract history	PSPC-awarded contract history analysis.	CanadaBuys -> Contract history [S12]
Standing offers / supply arrangements	Supplier capability/instrument intelligence and partner context.	CanadaBuys -> SOSA dataset [S12]

24. Attribution footer to place in the product

Example wording to review against the actual dataset-specific attribution requirements before production:

Suggested product footer

Contains information derived from Government of Canada open data / CanadaBuys. Source records remain authoritative. Reuse is subject to the applicable Open Government Licence - Canada and source-specific terms. BidScope One is an independent service and is not endorsed by the Government of Canada.

25. Import schedule

Job	MVP cadence	What happens
Open/current tenders	Every 1-3 hours	Download, validate, upsert, detect changes, create alert events.
Awards	Daily	Upsert new/amended award records; refresh buyer/supplier aggregates.
Contract history	Daily/weekly	Upsert history; rebuild materialized aggregate tables.
Standing offers / supply arrangements	Daily/weekly	Upsert and refresh supplier/instrument views.
Notification sender	Every few minutes	Process queued user alerts and record delivery result.
Retention/cleanup	Daily	Expire temporary signed-link metadata and stale upload processing artifacts.

26. Document privacy rules

- Customer-uploaded tender packages are private to the customer organization unless the user explicitly shares them.

- Use object keys that do not reveal company names or tender titles.
- Store encryption/access controls at the cloud-provider level and restrict application credentials.
- Do not copy customer documents into analytics or error-reporting tools.
- Set a documented retention policy. Let customers delete uploaded documents, subject to legitimate legal/accounting/security records you must retain.
- For partner data rooms, make access explicit, time-limited if possible, and logged.

PART VII - SECURITY, EMAIL, BILLING AND COMPLIANCE OPERATIONS

27. Security baseline before first paid customer

- MFA on domain registrar, GitHub, Supabase, Vercel, Stripe, email provider, Cloudflare and password manager.
- Separate staging and production environments.
- No secrets in Git. Add .env* to .gitignore; rotate any secret accidentally committed.
- RLS enabled and tested for every tenant-owned Supabase table.
- Private object storage; signed URLs; no public bucket for customer documents.
- Stripe-hosted Checkout/Customer Portal rather than raw card capture.
- Daily/managed database backups according to selected service tier; test restoration before claiming a backup process.
- Dependency updates and vulnerability checks monthly, faster for critical security notices.
- Audit events for login, profile changes, document sharing, partner-post changes, billing/admin changes.
- Incident plan with owner, containment steps, breach assessment and customer/regulatory notification path.

28. CASL-safe email architecture

Message type	Example	Implementation
Transactional	Password reset, invoice, account security notice.	Triggered by user/account event; send through transactional stream.
User-requested alerts	“A saved tender changed” / “closing in 72 hours”.	Store alert preference/consent and provide easy settings to stop them.
Marketing	Newsletter, promotion, upsell campaign.	Maintain CASL consent basis, sender identification/contact info and unsubscribe workflow; separate stream/list.

29. Stripe subscription setup

- 86. In Stripe Test Mode create Product: BidScope One Pro.
- 87. Create one monthly Price initially. Do not create five confusing plans before customer interviews.
- 88. Use Stripe Checkout for signup and Stripe Customer Portal for card update/cancellation.
- 89. Create a server endpoint that starts Checkout and passes internal organization_id as metadata.
- 90. Create a webhook endpoint. Verify Stripe webhook signatures before trusting events.
- 91. On checkout.session.completed / subscription updates, update subscription_status server-side.
- 92. Test successful card, failed card, expired card, cancellation, renewal and refund procedures in test mode.
- 93. Only switch to Live Mode after legal name, bank account, tax settings, receipt/support email and Terms/Privacy links are ready.

PART VIII - BUSINESS MODEL, PRICING, SALES AND LAUNCH

30. Start with simple pricing

Plan	Illustrative launch price	Includes
Free / Trial	\$0 or 14 days	Limited matches, save a few opportunities, sample intelligence.
Supplier Pro	\$99/month	Full matching, alerts/calendar, eligibility check limits, buyer/supplier intelligence.
Team	\$249/month	Multiple users, higher document limits, shared bid workspace, exports, partner posts.
Enterprise	Custom	SSO/security review, larger limits, onboarding, procurement-sales reporting.

These are proposed product prices, not market facts. Change them after paid customer interviews and observed usage.

31. First customer niche

Start with one Canadian supplier segment that already searches public tenders and has enough contract value to justify a monthly tool. Good testing niches include IT professional services, construction/trades, facility services, consulting and specialized equipment suppliers. Pick one; do not market to “every company in Canada” on day one.

32. First 20 customer process

94. Build a spreadsheet of 100 target suppliers in one vertical using public company websites and business directories. Do not harvest private data.
95. Ask 20 for a 20-minute workflow interview. The objective is to see how they currently find opportunities, why they skip bids, what requirements waste time, and what alerts they miss.
96. Offer 5-10 design partners free/discounted access for 30-60 days in exchange for weekly feedback and permission to measure product usage.
97. For the first customers, personally configure their company profile and watchlist. Record which fields actually determine good matches.
98. Charge before polishing every module. The moment Radar + Calendar reliably saves time, offer the paid plan.
99. Use Eligibility Checker as the second “wow” feature. Require users to confirm extracted mandatory items; measure false positives/false negatives.
100. Only build marketplace automation once customers repeatedly ask for partners/subcontractors.

33. Sales message

Positioning example

BidScope One helps Canadian suppliers find relevant public-sector opportunities, identify mandatory bid requirements, understand buyer history, fill capability gaps and manage bid deadlines - from one workspace. It links back to official sources and does not promise eligibility or award outcomes.

34. Key metrics

Metric	Why it matters
Profile -> first useful match time	Onboarding must create value quickly.
Match open rate	Are recommendations relevant?
Save/start-bid rate	Do opportunities translate into real pursuits?
Mandatory requirement correction rate	Measures Eligibility Checker extraction quality.
Alert-to-action rate	Do reminders/change notices produce useful action?
Weekly active organizations	Core engagement.
Trial -> paid conversion	Commercial fit.
Monthly churn	Whether value persists.
Support incidents involving data/privacy	Risk and operational quality.

PART IX - 90-DAY EXECUTION PLAN

35. Days 1-7 - company + design foundation

Day	Exact outcome
1	Choose working name; buy domain only after basic name/trademark checks; create password vault.
2	Create Ontario corporation or chosen structure; save corporate records; begin business-bank setup.
3	CRA/BizPaL/home-office review; create privacy/security compliance folder.
4	Install VS Code, Node LTS, GitHub Desktop, Figma. Create private repo and Next.js project.
5	Create Supabase staging/production and Vercel; deploy starter app.
6	Figma wireframes for onboarding, dashboard, opportunities and bid detail.
7	Finalize MVP scope: Opportunity Radar + Calendar only. Write 20 acceptance tests before coding.

36. Days 8-30 - first sellable MVP

Period	Build
Days 8-12	Auth, organizations, onboarding/company profile, RLS tests.
Days 13-17	CanadaBuys tender import, normalization, source links, update/change detection.
Days 18-21	Opportunity list/detail + deterministic match score/reasons/blocker flags.
Days 22-24	Save/Dismiss/Start Bid; bid project + task model.
Days 25-27	Email alerts, amendment/closing notifications, preferences.
Days 28-29	Stripe test-mode subscription + billing status.
Day 30	Security/QA pass and 3-5 design partners onboarded manually.

37. Days 31-60 - Eligibility Checker + intelligence

Period	Build
31-37	Private upload pipeline, document metadata/checksums, extraction with page references.
38-44	Requirement classifier/rules, checklist UI, user confirmation, evidence comparison.
45-49	Awards import and buyer/supplier normalization.
50-54	Contract history + standing offers import.
55-57	Buyer/supplier/category intelligence dashboards.
58-60	Customer testing, extraction accuracy review, permission/security testing.

38. Days 61-90 - Partner Network + production hardening

Period	Build
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61-67	Opt-in company directory and verified-profile workflow.
68-73	Partner posts linked to bid projects; deterministic partner matching.
74-78	Messaging/introduction request with consent and moderation/reporting.
79-82	Terms/Privacy final review, deletion/export support procedures, incident playbook.
83-86	Billing live-mode dry run, accounting/tax workflow, support mailbox/macros.
87-89	Load/performance test, backup restore test, RLS penetration-style tenant isolation tests.
90	Controlled paid launch to one vertical; no broad launch until support and match quality are stable.

APPENDIX A - PROJECT FOLDER STRUCTURE

```
bidscope-one/  
app/  
  (auth)/  
  dashboard/  
  opportunities/  
  bids/  
  intelligence/  
  partners/  
  settings/  
  api/  
    imports/  
    stripe/  
    webhooks/  
  components/  
  lib/  
    auth/  
    database/  
    matching/  
    procurement/  
    documents/  
    notifications/  
    billing/  
  scripts/  
    import-tenders.ts  
    import-awards.ts  
    import-contract-history.ts  
    import-standing-offers.ts  
  supabase/  
    migrations/  
  tests/  
    rls/  
    matching/  
    imports/  
    documents/  
  .env.local (never commit)  
  .env.example (names only; no real secrets)
```

APPENDIX B - STARTER SQL (SIMPLIFIED)

```
create table organizations (  
  id uuid primary key default gen_random_uuid(),  
  legal_name text not null,  
  trade_name text,  
  created_at timestamptz not null default now()  
);  
  
create table company_profiles (  
  organization_id uuid primary key references organizations(id) on delete cascade,  
  capabilities text[] default '{}',  
  regions text[] default '{}',  
  languages text[] default '{}',
```

```
target_min_value numeric,  
target_max_value numeric,  
profile_json jsonb not null default '{}':jsonb,  
updated_at timestampz not null default now()  
);  
  
create table tenders (  
id uuid primary key default gen_random_uuid(),  
source_id text not null unique,  
title text not null,  
buyer text,  
category text,  
opened_at timestampz,  
closes_at timestampz,  
status text,  
source_url text not null,  
source_updated_at timestampz,  
raw_hash text,  
raw_json jsonb not null default '{}':jsonb  
);  
  
create table matches (  
organization_id uuid references organizations(id) on delete cascade,  
tender_id uuid references tenders(id) on delete cascade,  
score int check (score between 0 and 100),  
factors jsonb not null default '{}':jsonb,  
mandatory_risks jsonb not null default '[]':jsonb,  
created_at timestampz not null default now(),  
primary key (organization_id, tender_id)  
);
```

This schema is intentionally simplified. Add indexes, constraints, RLS policies, audit fields and migration testing before production.

APPENDIX C - ENVIRONMENT VARIABLES

Variable	Where	Rule
NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL	Vercel env + local .env.local	Public project URL is okay; still separate staging/prod.
NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY	Vercel env + local	Designed for client use with RLS; never treat it as admin access.
SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY	Server-only secret	Never browser, never commit.
R2_ACCOUNT_ID / ACCESS_KEY / SECRET	Server-only	Least privilege to required bucket/actions.
STRIPE_SECRET_KEY	Server-only	Never client-side.
STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET	Server-only	Verify every webhook signature.
POSTMARK_SERVER_TOKEN	Server-only	Restrict to sending purpose; rotate if exposed.
SENTRY_DSN	Configured per SDK	Filter sensitive content.
POSTHOG_KEY	Configured as intended	Do not send private documents/PII unnecessarily.

APPENDIX D - LAUNCH QA CHECKLIST

- ☐ Create two fake customer organizations. Confirm Org A cannot read/edit Org B records by changing IDs in URLs/API calls.
- ☐ Upload a private document as Org A. Confirm Org B cannot retrieve it and that object URLs expire.
- ☐ Import the same tender file twice. Confirm no duplicate tender rows.
- ☐ Change a tender closing date in staging test data. Confirm one amendment event and expected alert, not repeated spam.
- ☐ Test timezone display and DST around closing dates; store canonical timestamps and display user/target locale clearly.
- ☐ Test a company profile with a known mandatory mismatch. Confirm the blocker remains visible even with high relevance score.
- ☐ Eligibility Checker: manually compare at least 50 extracted mandatory requirements across representative documents; log misses/false positives and do not market accuracy you have not measured.
- ☐ Click every official-source link in a staging release.
- ☐ Test CASL unsubscribe/preferences and confirm suppression is respected.
- ☐ Test Stripe success, failure, cancellation, webhook replay/idempotency and customer portal.
- ☐ Test backup restoration procedure, not just backup existence.
- ☐ Test account deletion/export support workflow.
- ☐ Review privacy policy, terms, open-data attribution and support/contact information on production domain.
- ☐ Confirm marketing language does not imply government endorsement, guaranteed eligibility or guaranteed award.

APPENDIX E - TOOL DOWNLOAD / SIGN-UP LINKS

Ontario business registration: <https://www.ontario.ca/page/business/start/register-your-business-online> - Ontario Business Registry entry point and fees/requirements.

CRA business registration: <https://www.canada.ca/en/services/taxes/business-registration.html> - Business Number and CRA program accounts.

GST/HST registration: <https://www.canada.ca/en/revenue-agency/services/tax/businesses/topics/gst-hst-businesses/gst-hst-account/register-account.html> - CRA GST/HST registration guidance.

BizPaL: <https://bizpal.ca/> - Permit/licence discovery by jurisdiction and activity.

CanadaBuys data: <https://canadabuys.canada.ca/en/procurement-and-contracting-data> - Official procurement datasets.

Open Government Licence: <https://open.canada.ca/en/open-government-licence-canada> - Commercial reuse conditions and attribution.

VS Code: <https://code.visualstudio.com/Download> - Windows/macOS/Linux installer.

Node.js: <https://nodejs.org/en/download> - Use current LTS for the project unless a dependency requires otherwise.

GitHub Desktop: <https://desktop.github.com/download/> - Desktop Git client.

Figma: <https://www.figma.com/downloads/> - Desktop design app; web also works.

Next.js docs: <https://nextjs.org/docs> - Framework documentation.

Supabase: <https://supabase.com/dashboard> - Managed Postgres/Auth project dashboard.

Vercel: <https://vercel.com/signup> - Hosting/deployment account.

Cloudflare R2: <https://developers.cloudflare.com/r2/get-started/> - Object storage setup.

Stripe: <https://dashboard.stripe.com/register> - Payments/Billing account.

Stripe Connect: <https://stripe.com/connect> - Later marketplace/payout tooling; legal analysis still required for your exact flow.

Postmark: <https://postmarkapp.com/> - Transactional email.

Sentry: <https://sentry.io/signup/> - Error monitoring.

PostHog: <https://posthog.com/> - Product analytics.

Bitwarden: <https://bitwarden.com/download/> - Password manager option.

1Password: <https://1password.com/downloads/> - Password manager option.

APPENDIX F - VERIFIED SOURCES / WHAT THEY SUPPORT

ID	Source	Supports	URL
S1	Ontario - Register your business online	Ontario lists Business Corporation at \$300 online and sole proprietorship at \$60; named corporation NUANS requirement.	https://www.ontario.ca/page/business/start/register-your-business-online
S2	Ontario - Setting up Ontario Business Registry profile	Ontario.ca Login, Ontario Business Account and company-key workflow for existing entities.	https://www.ontario.ca/page/setting-your-ontario-business-registry-profile
S3	CRA - Business registration	Business Number/program-account registration; CRA business registration entry point.	https://www.canada.ca/en/services/taxes/business-registration.html
S4	CRA - GST/HST registration / when to register	GST/HST registration process and small-supplier rules.	https://www.canada.ca/en/revenue-agency/services/tax/businesses/topics/gst-hst-businesses/gst-hst-account/register-account.html
S5	BizPaL	Government permit/licence discovery service; exact results depend on business facts/location.	https://bizpal.ca/
S6	City of Ottawa - Zoning By-law 2026-50, s.301	Home-based business conditions under current zoning by-law.	https://ottawa.ca/en/living-ottawa/laws-licences-and-permits/laws/laws-z/zoning-law-law-no-2026-50/part-3-specific-use-provisions
S7	Office of the Privacy Commissioner - Privacy Guide for Businesses	PIPEDA responsibilities, consent, breach and privacy-principle guidance.	https://www.priv.gc.ca/en/privacy-topics/privacy-laws-in-canada/the-personal-information-protection-and-electronic-documents-act-

			pipeda/pipeda-compliance-help/guide_org/
S8	ISED - Getting consent to send email	CASL consent basics, sender info and unsubscribe expectations.	https://ised-isde.canada.ca/site/canada-anti-spam-legislation/en/getting-consent-send-email
S9	Open Government Licence - Canada	Permits commercial use subject to conditions including attribution and non-endorsement.	https://open.canada.ca/en/open-government-licence-canada
S10	Bank of Canada - Supervisory policy for online marketplaces	When marketplace payment activities may fall within RPAA scope.	https://www.bankofcanada.ca/2025/12/supervisory-policy-for-online-marketplaces/
S11	FINTRAC - Money services businesses	MSB registration context; do not assume a custom funds flow is unregulated.	https://fintrac-canafe.canada.ca/public/businesses-entreprises-eng
S12	CanadaBuys - Procurement and contracting data	Official downloadable tender, award, contract-history and standing-offer/supply-arrangement datasets and stated analytic uses.	https://canadabuys.canada.ca/en/procurement-and-contracting-data

FINAL BUILD ORDER - THE SHORT VERSION

101. Create/legalize the company and business accounts.
102. Install development tools and create secure staging/production environments.
103. Build auth + company profile.
104. Ingest official open tender data.
105. Build transparent opportunity matching.
106. Build save/start-bid + deadline calendar + change alerts.
107. Get 5-10 companies using this before expanding.
108. Add private document upload and traceable Eligibility Checker.
109. Add award/contract/SOSA intelligence.
110. Add opt-in Partner Network only after you know which capability gaps customers repeatedly need.
111. Use third-party payment providers; avoid custom escrow/wallet flows.
112. Launch narrowly, measure accuracy/usefulness, then expand categories/jurisdictions.

The goal

The finished company is not “five random tender tools.” It is one operating system for a supplier's government-sales workflow: discover -> qualify -> research -> team -> manage -> learn.